Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)	**CHEMISTRY**		
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)		Interdisciplinary framework:	
Research question:	**Is acetaminophen as effective as aspirin (acetylsalicylic acid) as an inhibitor of cyclooxigenase-1 (COX-1) catalysis of arachidonic acid metabolism, determined by calculating the IC_{50} values?**		
Assessment details			
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)	
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**5**	The RQ is relevant to the topic of investigation. It is clear and focused but stated as a yes/no answer type question. (5) Research methods that are suitable for the RQ are explained and applied effectively. (6) Structural conventions used in the essay support communication of the research, but use of tables to present information different from results should be avoided. (4)	
B: Knowledge and understanding [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	Relevant research materials are used to establish knowledge of the subject matter. (4) Relevant terminology is used accurately and in a most consistent fashion to demonstrate understanding of the subject matter, with minor flaws. (5) Some relevant concepts are explained and used effectively to demonstrate understanding of the subject matter, with flaws. (4)	
C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**6**	Analysis in the essay is simple, though effective, and produces relevant findings. (5) There is a clear line of argument which links the RQ, findings and conclusions. (6)	
D: Discussion and evaluation [Maximum possible mark: 8]	**6**	There is a good discussion of the significance of the findings which is often supported by appropriate evidence. (6) An evaluation of the effectiveness of the essay is present, with mostly relevant strengths and limitations explained. (6)	
E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**2**	Reflection on the extended essay is mainly descriptive and includes some specific examples (2) Reflection shows some evidence of the student´s growth and transfer of learning (2)	
Total marks awarded	23/30		
Holistic comment on the essay:			

	All in all, a fairly good piece of work where the topic is framed within context, and there is a consistent attempt to focus on the terms of the RQ—a complex topic, which is well handled by a high school student. The conclusion tries to bring existing knowledge and the evaluation, while mainly based on procedural issues, has some insight.